



MANAGING PREMENSTRUAL SYNDROME (PMS)

Premenstrual syndrome can cause uncomfortable physical and emotional symptoms before menstruation. Although PMS cannot be completely prevented, many people can manage symptoms effectively through lifestyle changes and medical treatments.

Learning how to manage PMS can improve comfort, mood, and overall well-being.

Lifestyle Changes That May Help

Helpful strategies include:

- Regular exercise such as walking, swimming, or cycling
- Getting enough sleep each night
- Managing stress through relaxation techniques
- Eating a balanced diet
- Reducing caffeine, alcohol, and salty foods before menstruation

Medical Treatments for PMS

Healthcare providers may recommend:

- Over-the-counter pain relievers
- Hormonal birth control
- Antidepressants such as SSRIs
- Diuretics for bloating and fluid retention

Always consult a healthcare provider before starting medications or supplements.

PMS vs PMDD

PMDD is a more severe form of PMS and may include:

- Severe depression
- Intense irritability or anger
- Anxiety
- Difficulty functioning in daily life

PMDD may require medical treatment and professional care.

Key Takeaway

PMS is common and can often be managed through healthy habits and medical support when needed. Tracking symptoms and working with a healthcare provider can help individuals find the most effective strategies.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

Educational content informed by Cleveland Clinic. Premenstrual Syndrome. (2025)
American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists. Premenstrual Syndrome (PMS).
Hantsoo, L., et al. (2022). Premenstrual symptoms across the lifespan. Archives of Women's Mental Health.